

TB Distortion

DETAILED ENGLISH USER MANUAL

A two-layer distortion system with six main drive curves, level-dependent dynamics, a parallel TB character stage, focus filters, and mix/output control.



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Host-visible endpoints documented: 11

1. Product purpose

A two-layer distortion system with six main drive curves, level-dependent dynamics, a parallel TB character stage, focus filters, and mix/output control.

One distortion curve rarely covers subtle saturation, broken-speaker aggression, folded digital motion, and reactive dynamics. TB Distortion combines a main drive engine with an independently controlled TB layer so color can be built in parallel rather than forced through one serial algorithm.

What result it creates

- Controlled harmonic enrichment
- Aggressive clipping and folding textures
- Input-responsive distortion movement
- Band-focused parallel character without unnecessary low-end damage

Signal flow

Input -> Low/High focus filters -> selected main drive curve with Dynamics -> parallel TB character layer -> Mix -> Output

2. Complete feature guide

Main Drive and Drive Type

Drive feeds Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, or Fold shaping. Soft and Tube are progressive; Hard and Fuzz are more abrupt; Tape rounds transients; Fold creates complex non-linear inversion.

Dynamics

Negative and positive Dynamics settings change how distortion intensity follows input level. Use small values first; extremes intentionally exaggerate movement.

TB layer

TB Drive controls the parallel character layer. Level, Sample, Time, and Bias types introduce different amplitude, stepped, time-varying, or asymmetrical behavior.

Low and High focus

The steep focus limits define which region is emphasized by the distortion structure. Raise Low to protect sub-bass; lower High to keep fizz out of the result.

Mix and Output

Mix blends the complete processed path with the original. Output compensates level so tone decisions are not confused with loudness.

Factory Programs

Programs move from clean heat and tube bloom to diode crack, worn reel, folded motion, and radio breakdown. Treat them as routings and gain-stage starting points.

3. Quick start

1. Set Mix to 100 percent and Output for safe headroom.
2. Choose a Drive Type and raise Drive to the desired core texture.
3. Set Low and High to protect or emphasize a band.
4. Adjust Dynamics for reactive movement.
5. Add TB Drive and choose its type.
6. Back Mix down for parallel use, then level-match Output.

4. Practical workflows

Parallel vocal grit

1. Choose Tube or Tape.
2. Raise Low to keep plosives clean.
3. Add a small Bias or Sample TB layer.
4. Reduce Mix until diction remains clear.

Expected result: The vocal gains urgency and harmonic detail while remaining intelligible.

Destroyed drum loop

1. Choose Fold or Fuzz.
2. Drive hard and narrow the focus range.
3. Use Time or Sample TB character.
4. Automate Mix for transitions.

Expected result: The loop becomes unstable and aggressive while the dry path can preserve impact.

5. Automation, gain staging, and session use

- Automate only controls that serve a clear musical transition. Fast movement of frequency, time, pitch, mode, oversampling, or algorithm selectors may intentionally create artifacts or require a host-safe transition.
- Match perceived loudness before judging quality. A louder setting will often appear better even when the processing decision is not better.
- Use the plug-in bypass endpoint for comparison and preserve an unprocessed source or earlier project version.
- Factory programs are starting points. Loading a program changes multiple parameters; save a new DAW preset after adapting it to the source.
- The parameter appendix is captured from the installed VST3 host contract. It lists every host-visible endpoint, its displayed range/options, default, automation status, and identifier.

6. Limits, cautions, and troubleshooting

- High Drive and Fold settings can create strong aliasing and level increase.
- Protect monitoring level before changing presets.
- Use Output to compare at equal loudness.

- No audible change: confirm the plug-in and relevant sub-block are enabled, Mix/Amount is not at a neutral value, and the source contains energy in the processed region.
- Unexpected level: return input, output, send, feedback, and parallel-mix controls to conservative values, then rebuild the setting one block at a time.
- Automation does not match the panel: reload the project, confirm the DAW is addressing the current plug-in version, and check whether a factory program or state recall replaced values.
- Clicks or transitions: avoid sample-instant changes to algorithm, time, pitch, mode, or oversampling selectors unless the sound is intentional.

7. Complete host parameter reference

This appendix contains all 11 parameters exposed by the current installed VST3 to a host. Repeated EQ-band endpoints are intentionally listed rather than collapsed. Discrete options are printed in full when the host contract exposes them.

Parameter	Range / options	Default	Host status	Function
Bypass VST3 ID 1652125811	Off, On	Off	Automatable; Bypass	Turns the complete plug-in processing path off or on through the host-visible bypass endpoint.
Drive VST3 ID 95852938	0.0 to 36.0	6.0	Automatable	Controls or enables non-linear density, harmonic color, or peak shaping.
Drive Type VST3 ID 780322788	Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, Fold	Soft	Automatable	Selects the operating algorithm, response shape, or tonal character for the named block.
Dynamics VST3 ID 1443276820	-100.0 to 100.0	0.0	Automatable	Host-automatable control for Dynamics. Its full range and default are shown in this table; use it with the related feature section above.
High VST3 ID 3202466	20 to 20000	20000	Automatable	Host-automatable control for High. Its full range and default are shown in this table; use it with the related feature section above.
Low VST3 ID 107348	20 to 20000	20	Automatable	Host-automatable control for Low. Its full range and default are shown in this table; use it with the related feature section above.
Mix VST3 ID 108124	0.0 to 100.0	100.0	Automatable	Sets the balance between the original signal and the complete processed path.
Output VST3 ID 1141971201	-24.0 to 12.0	0.0	Automatable	Sets or limits the final output level after the plug-in's main processing.
Program VST3 ID 1886548852	Init, Clean Heat, Tube Bloom, Diode Crack, Broken Cone, Worn Reel, Parallel Mid Dirt, Folded Motion, Radio Breakdown	Init	Automatable	Selects a factory program. Loading a program recalls a coordinated set of plug-in parameters.
TB Drive VST3 ID 595685308	0.0 to 100.0	0.0	Automatable	Controls or enables non-linear density, harmonic color, or peak shaping.
TB Type VST3 ID 1266625224	Level, Sample, Time, Bias	Level	Automatable	Selects the operating algorithm, response shape, or tonal character for the named block.

Documentation basis

Prepared from the current public catalog, current local product brief and implementation notes where available, existing English manuals where available, and a direct scan of the installed VST3 host contract. Internal implementation details that are not user-facing are intentionally excluded; all user-facing features and host-visible controls are documented.